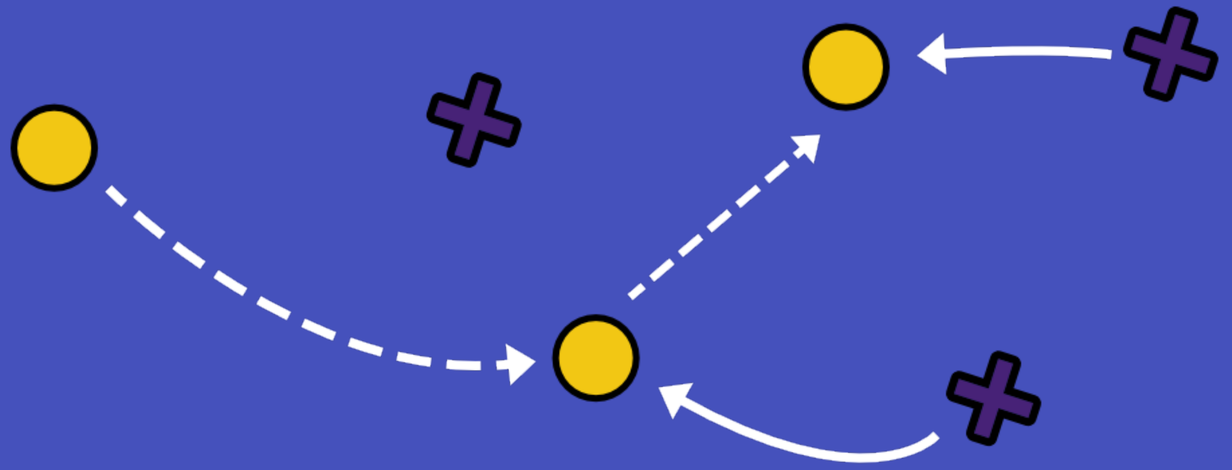
EAST HULL FALCONS FOOTBALL PLAYBOOK 2026-2030



ACCREDITED
PART OF ENGLAND FOOTBALL

TEAMWORK, RESPECT & FAIRPLAY

RESPECT THE STANDARD

INTRODUCTION

Hello and welcome to our playbook for our current youth teams that takes us from 2026 through to 2030.

This document encloses various bits of information to help you understand and recognise the direction of travel we are on, and the vision we have for these teams and the children that play within them.

Within this document you will understand who we are as a football club and what we stand for.

It also explains how us as coaches will look to coach and develop the children, how we look to play on a match-day, how we look to support them on this journey, and how themselves as players can fulfil their individual ambitions and aspirations.

At the end of the document, and the most important for parents and guardians, are our top tips and recommendations for you as a parent of a youth football player, and how you have a big part to play in their football experience as part of our Falcons football family.

We hope this proves useful and if you have any questions then please do not hesitate to contact me on the details below.

I will finish by saying a huge thank you for choosing us as the place for your children to enjoy their football, we value the trust you place in all the volunteers at our football club and we look forward to the years we will spend together come wind, rain or shine.

Many thanks, Tom Lee.

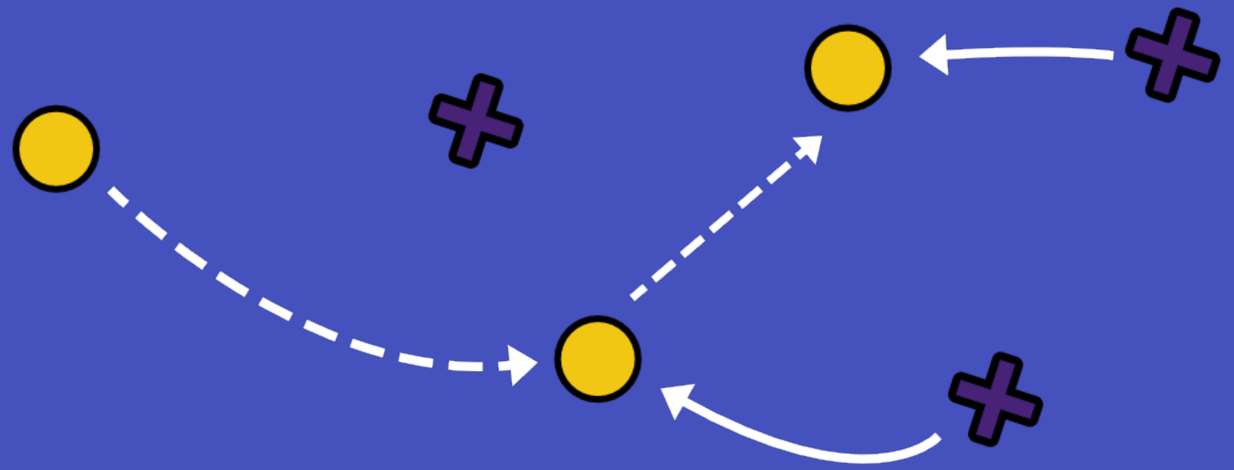
tomlee1150@gmail.com

07378775496

EAST HULL FALCONS

FOOTBALL CLUB

WHO WE ARE



WHO WE ARE

We are East Hull Falcons Football Club.

Through our passion for football, we have developed youth football teams for boys and girls to play in the Hull and District Youth Football League. We are based from Alderman Cogan Primary School and will travel to various parts of the East Riding County to experience football matches weekly.

These teams will join our East Hull Falcons Family of which already have a Girls team that plays fixtures within the East Riding Girls League on a Saturday.

The Club is an England Football Accredited club which means we meet all the standards set out by The English Football Association (The FA) to be recognised as a club providing the right environment for all to experience their football, with volunteers holding all the required qualifications and the club having the relevant policies and safeguards in place.

The club is completely run by volunteers who commit their time to give something back to the children and the community through football. We have a dedicated committee to oversee the direction and running of the club as well as a Club Welfare officer who alongside the committee, ensure we all adhere to the safeguarding standards and demonstrate the right behaviours to keep football safe and fun for all to enjoy.

Our club is built around one simple goal: to provide children with a safe, supportive, and fun environment where they can learn, play, and grow through football.

Our coaches and volunteers are passionate to make sure every interaction is a positive one. We believe in teamwork, respect, and fair play—on and off the pitch.

Best wishes, the Falcons Football Family.

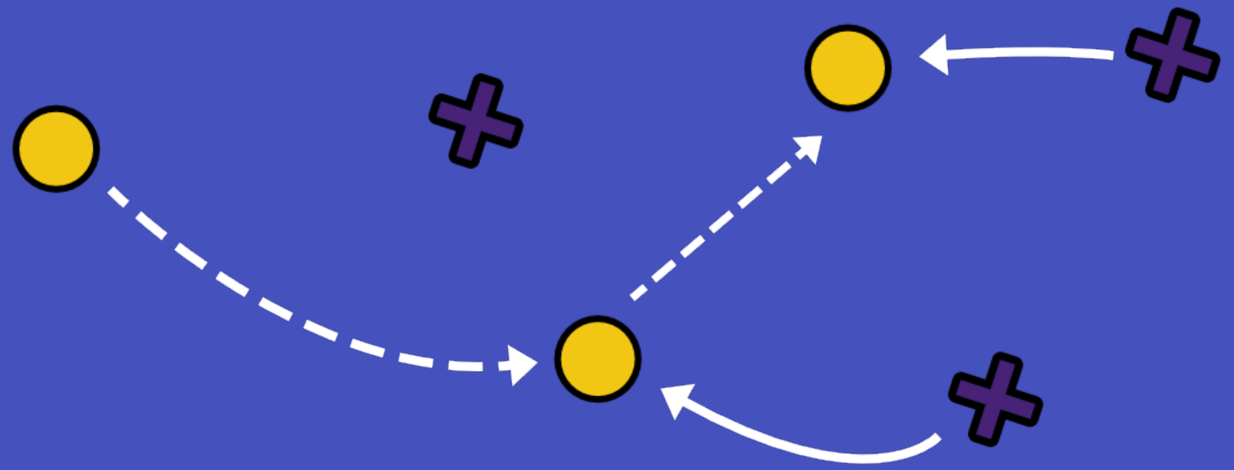
OUR STRATEGY

OUR VISION	To empower children to explore and find their potential through the power of football.				
OUR MISSION	To create an enjoyable place for children to express themselves without fear, encourage them to be creative and develop them as well-rounded individuals through experiencing the beautiful game.				
OUR GOALS	PEOPLE	PLACES	PURPOSE	PLAYERS	
OUR GOALS	To shape a community that supports the development of our children with skills and attributes for life, both on and beyond the pitch.	To create safe, fun and inclusive environments wherever we come together as a team or as a community.	To strive for something greater than ourselves by being a club that serves and represents their community as a collective.	To develop our children into the football players they desire to be, helping them with their individual goals and aspirations.	
OUR VALUES	TEAMWORK, RESPECT AND FAIR-PLAY				

EAST HULL FALCONS

FOOTBALL CLUB

HOW WE PLAY



ATTACKING & DEFENDING

We want children to be CONFIDENT footballers with the skills to play with both feet. A player who is BRAVE on the ball and look to KEEP THE BALL on the pitch no matter how many players are around them, the amount of pressure they are under and no matter where you are on the pitch.

We will ALWAYS ENCOURAGE players to try to do this, with the FREEDOM to make mistakes as we are looking at long term player development, not the finished article right now.

ATTACKING

Be confident to stay on the ball and keep the ball with our team.

Create space for each other and be available for a pass through clever movement and finding space.

Try to dribble or run with the ball.

Pass the ball to others in a good position to keep the ball.

Try to shoot when there is opportunity.

DEFENDING

Look to tackle if the ball is able to be won.

To look to cut out passes made by the opposition.

Make other team players make decisions or mistakes by putting pressure on them.

Help our player who is putting pressure on the ball by marking the teams other players.

Provide cover and make the pitch small and compact through our shape and positions, protecting our goal.

PHASES OF THE GAME

The game of football is usually simply understood as Attacking and Defending, essentially what we want to do when we have the ball (attacking) versus what we need to do when we do not have the ball (defending).

But, there are three main phases to the game of football, they are 1. With the ball (in possession), 2. Without the ball (out of possession), 3. With or without the ball (transition). For the period of this playbook we will focus much more on in possession and out of possession, transition will come in future periods of development.

There are also the different aspects (principles of play) of attacking and defending that can be applied depending on the phase of the game we are in as a team, which then asks the question of players to apply the best technical and tactical decisions to what is happening.

Below this is broken down into what are the principles of play we will be focusing on for attacking and defending for this period of the playbook and the technical components we want the children to develop.

ATTACKING

TECHNICAL COMPONENTS	PRINCIPLES OF PLAY
Passing	Penetration
Receiving	Create space
Turning	Movement
Dribbling	Support
Shooting	Creativity

DEFENDING

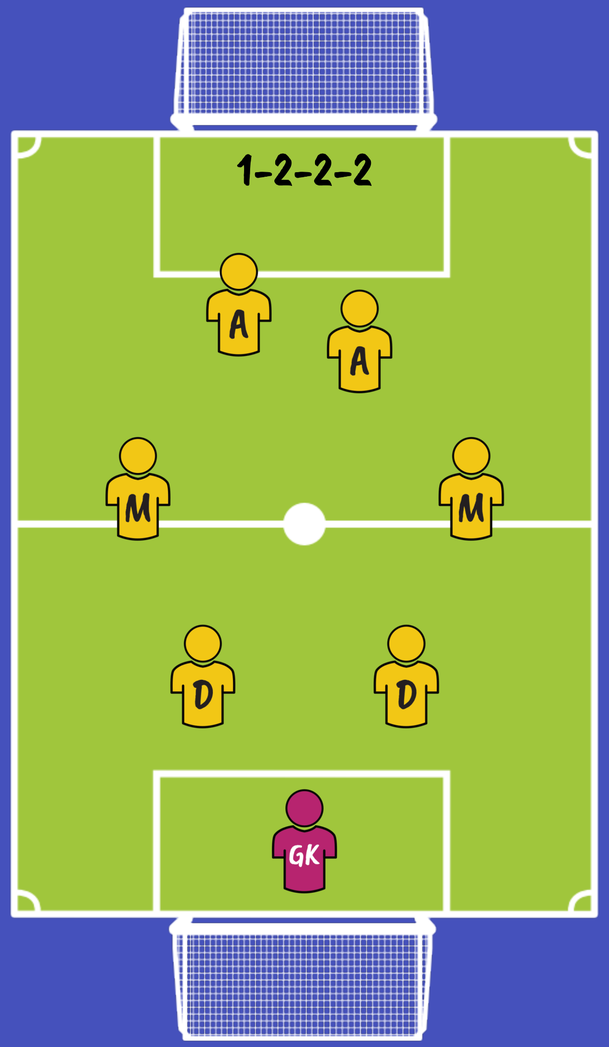
PRINCIPLES OF PLAY	TECHNICAL COMPONENTS
Press	Tackling
Delay	Intercepting
Cover & Balance	Pressing
Compactness	Marking
Control & Restraint	Covering

7v7 FORMATIONS

Over the period of playing the 7v7 format of the game we will explore the different formations below. This will be for us to provide the opportunity for all children to experience the different positions on the pitch, how to attack and defend in groups and prepare them for the transition to 9v9 and then 11v11 formats of the game.





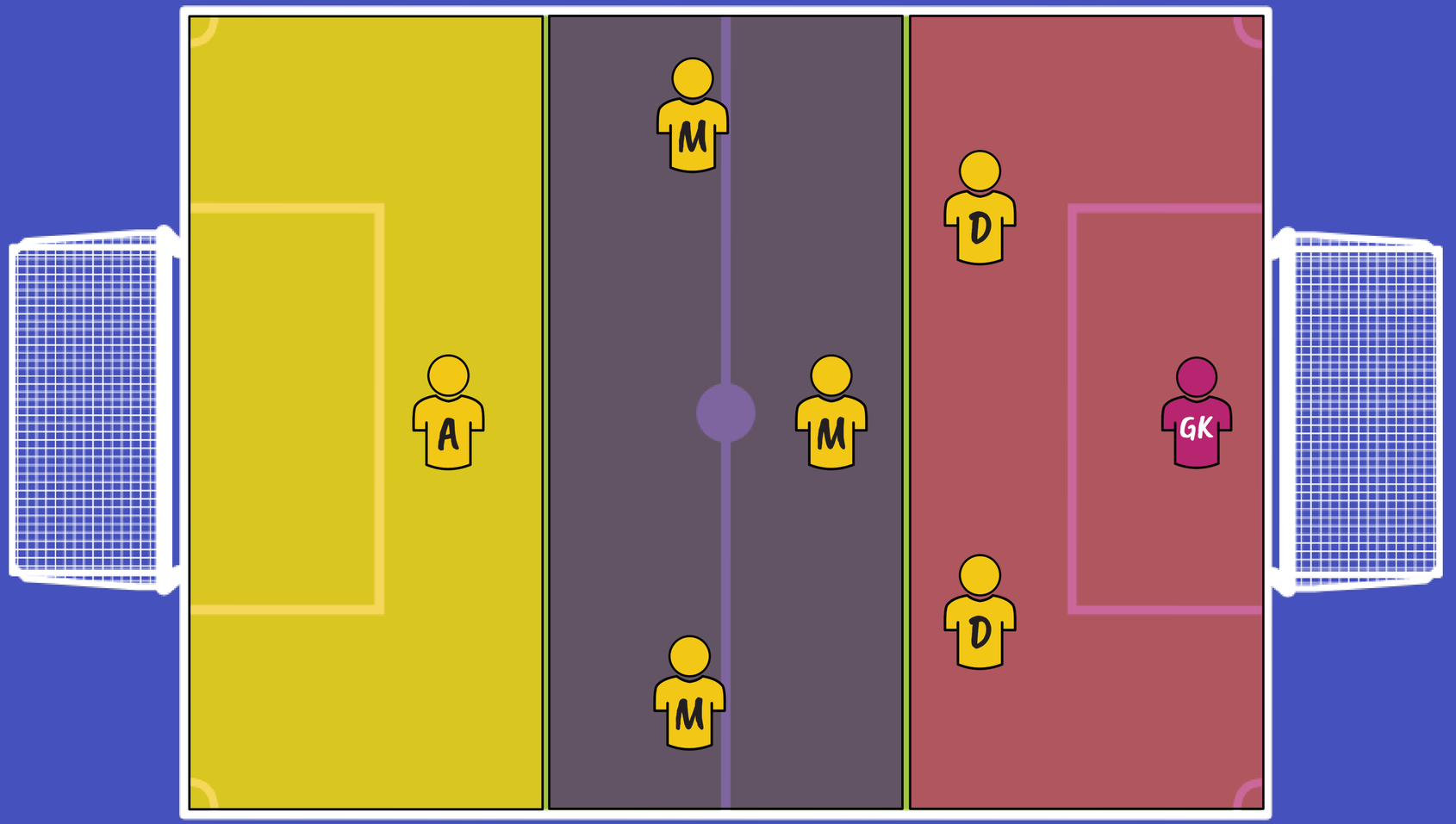


PITCH THIRDS

Whether we are with or without the ball we want the players to understand the pitch broken down into thirds.

We have the defensive 3rd, which is the first third from the goal we are defending, the middle 3rd is the area across the centre of the pitch and the final 3rd is the third furthest away from our goal / the goal we are trying to score in.

Below you can see the example of each third and where our players look to occupy these thirds in a 7v7 formation example.



DEFENSIVE 3RD

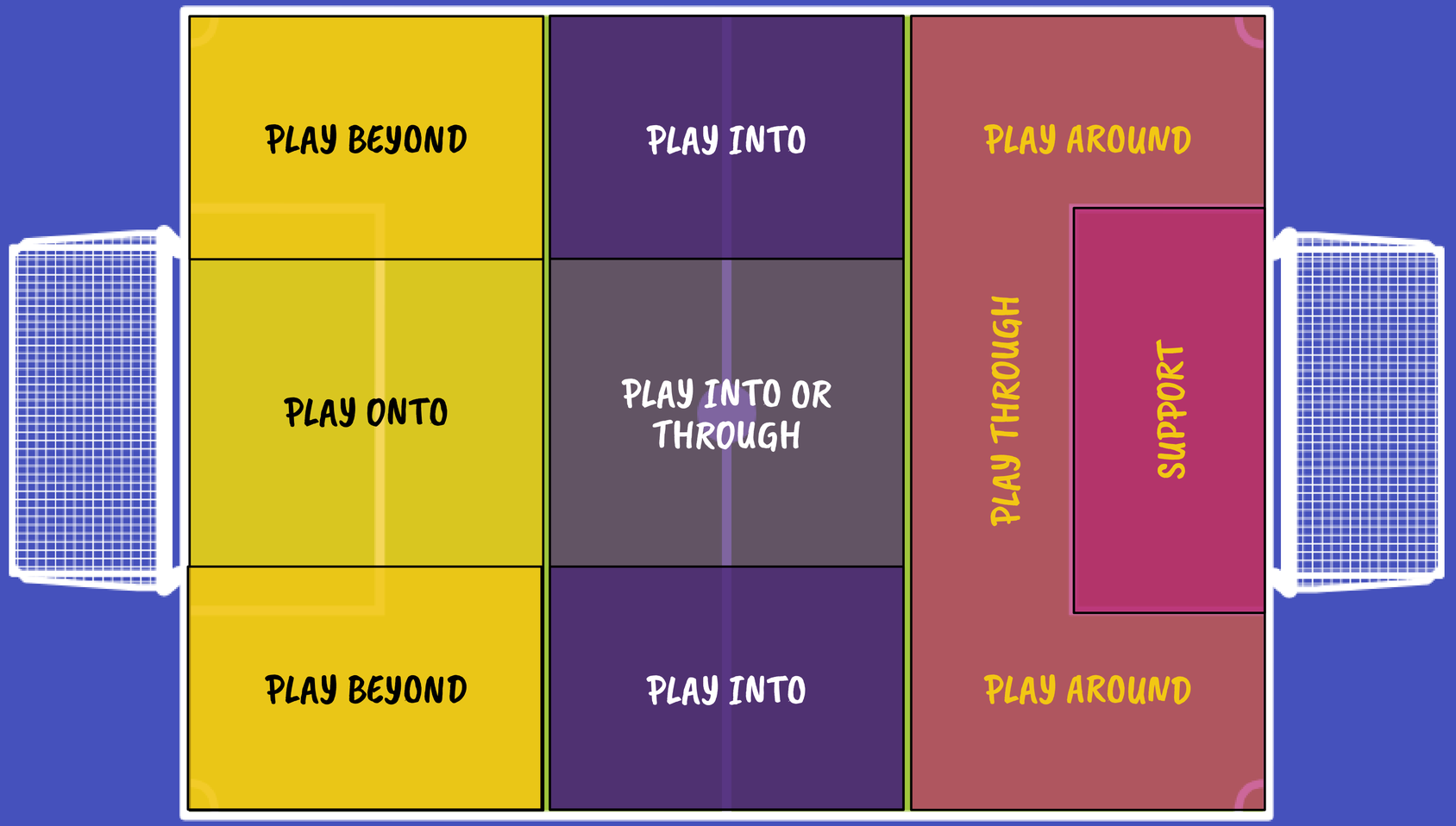
MIDDLE 3RD

FINAL 3RD

WITH THE BALL

When we have the ball this is our opportunity to allow the children to be creative, find solutions and expose opportunities to express themselves individually or together.

Below is not set in stone and is just a guide on how we will help the players make decisions when looking to attack through passing, dribbling or running with the ball. This is to help them get the ball up the pitch in what we believe to be the simplest and most effective way, but can quickly change our approach depending on what the opposition do.



SUPPORT: To occupy the whole area and provide support in relation to where the ball is on the pitch

PLAY AROUND: To play around the opposition by using the space available

PLAY THROUGH: To play passes or dribble through the 'lines' of the opposition

PLAY INTO OR THROUGH: To play into our players or play passes / dribble through the 'lines' of the opposition

PLAY INTO: To play into our players or play passes into the space for players to run onto

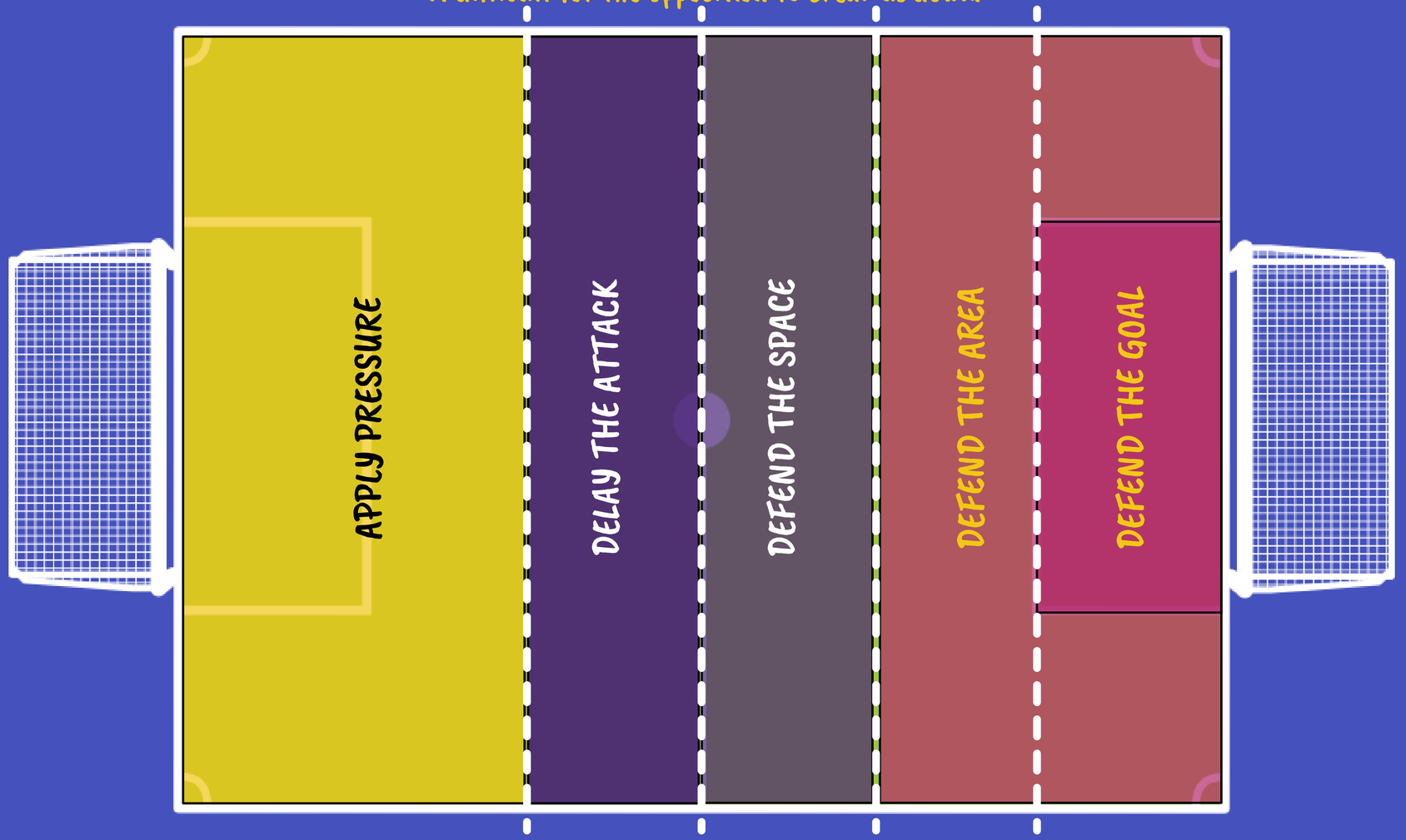
PLAY ONTO: To play into our furthest player forward to create scoring opportunities

PLAY BEYOND: To play into the furthest and widest space behind their defenders

WITHOUT THE BALL

When we are without the ball this is our opportunity to start to be more considered with our defending, occupying spaces, being in shape and compact together, marking opposition players and being able to cut out their passes.

Below are areas of the pitch that we will help the children understand that each has a different approach, and begin to move away from everyone trying to tackle the one player with the ball and chase the ball around the pitch, making it difficult for the opposition to break us down.



DEFENSIVE LINES: Depending how far up the pitch the opposition are, these are the defensive lines we occupy goal side to hinder their progress towards our goal

DEFEND THE GOAL: To make good tackles and blocks to stop them scoring

DEFEND THE AREA: To tackle, intercept passes or mark players

DEFEND THE SPACE: To be close together to make it difficult for them to attack towards our goal centrally

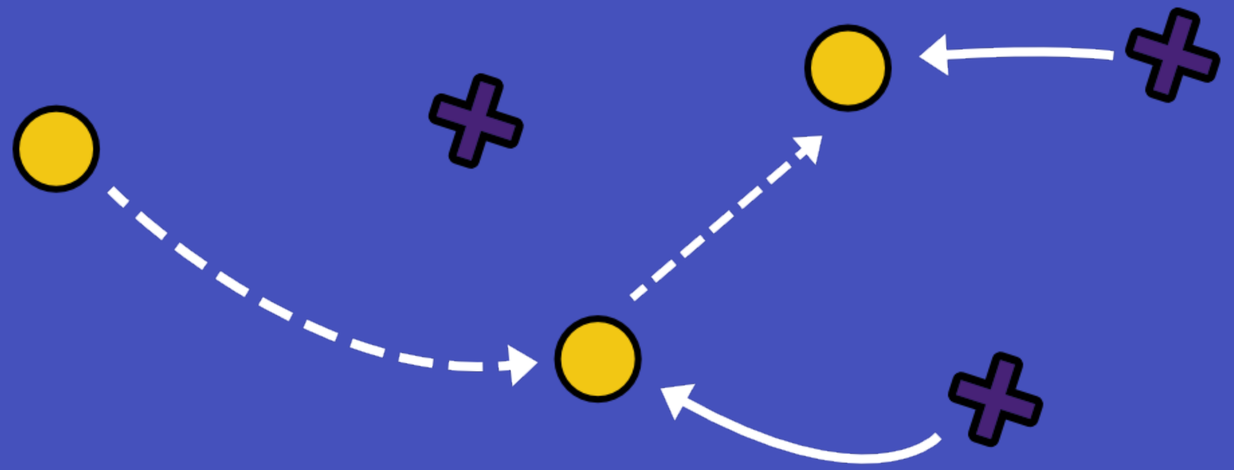
DELAY THE ATTACK: To delay them attacking or stop them playing through the middle of the pitch

APPLY PRESSURE: To put pressure on the ball through our striker, win the ball high up the pitch if we can tackle their defenders

EAST HULL FALCONS

FOOTBALL CLUB

HOW WE COACH



PLANNING AND DELIVERY

When it comes to training sessions we always plan to adhere to certain principles to support the children's development and get the best outcomes in the time we have available.

To give you context, how we deliver coaching sessions can be understood in 3 ways, these are 1. Constant practice, 2. Variable practice, 3. Random practice.

Constant practice: This is when a player repeats a specific technique, skill or movement in the same way over and over, to build up their confidence, capability and understanding.

Variable practice: This is when a player practices a technique, skill or movement but in different scenarios, to help them differentiate how to execute them depending on the situation they are in.

Random practice: This is when a player practices techniques, skills and movements in a forever moving and changing environment, to help them transfer their ability and learning into what a game / match-day creates.

We will always balance our delivery across constant, variable and random practice in relation to what the coaching session focus and outcomes are and what the children's current ability level and understanding is.

OUR COACHING PRINCIPLES

THE BALL

We will do 90% of everything we do with a football involved.

THE PITCH

We will replicate the playing pitch in training to help players with space and movement.

THE GAME

We will always keep everything we do connected back to the game and a match-day.

COACHING PITCHES

When it comes to coaching sessions and practices we will use ways in which the children can understand the pitch as different areas.

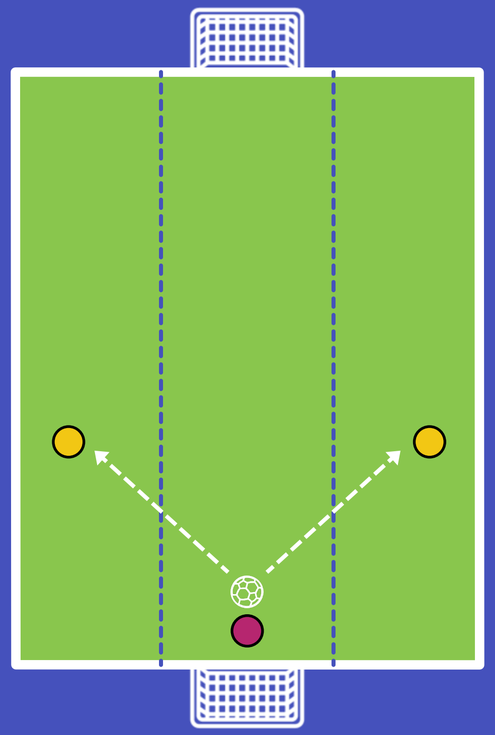
This will help them begin to find and understand space and distances to provide options when we have the ball, and to provide cover and balance when we are without the ball.

Below are the examples of how we will break up the pitch and introduce them by linking these areas to coaching outcomes.

"CHANNELS"

HELPS PLAYERS TO FIND WIDTH

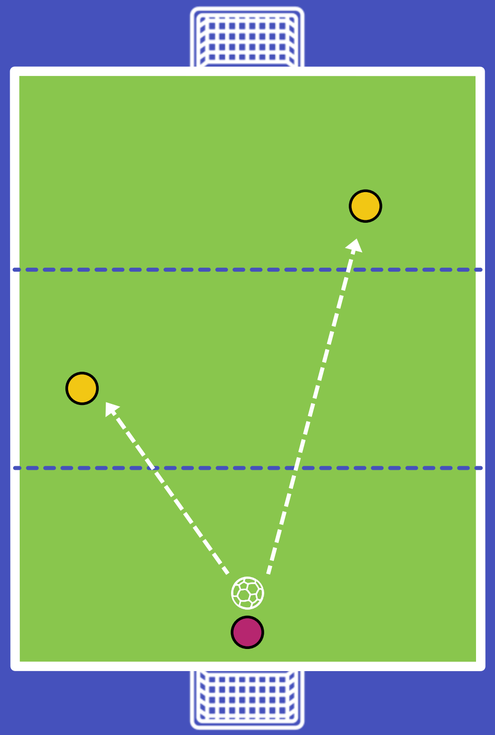
Example: "Try to get the ball in the right or left channel from the goalkeeper"



"THIRDS"

HELPS PLAYERS TO STRETCH THE PITCH

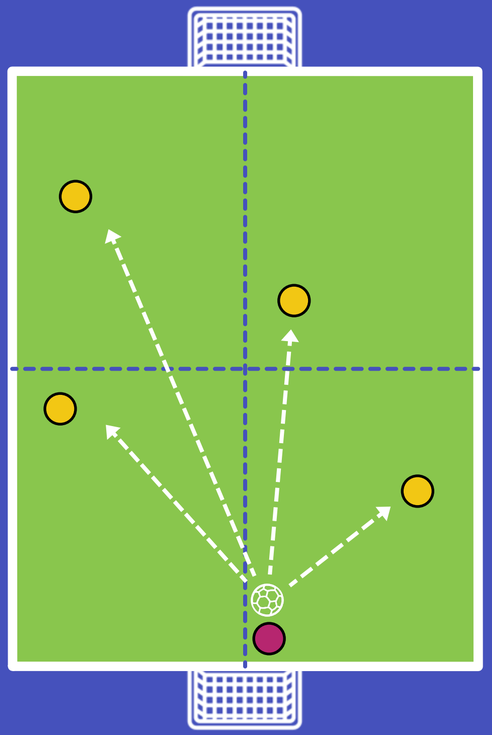
Example: "GK try to find a player in the middle or end third"



"QUARTERS"

HELPS PLAYERS UNDERSTAND SPACE

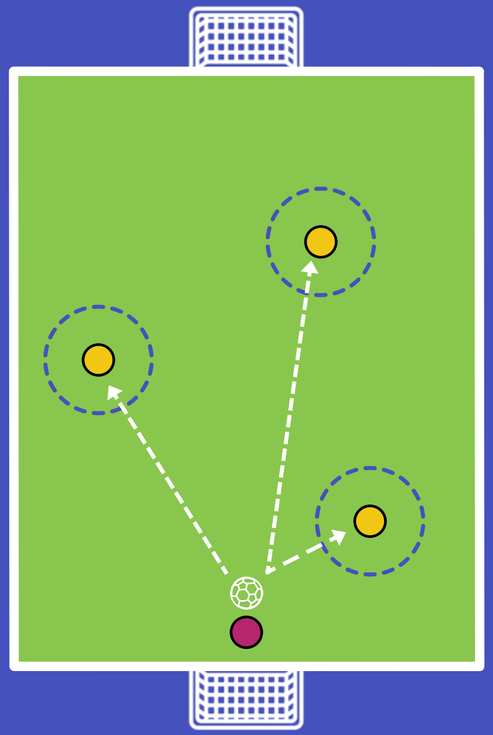
Example: 5V5 Ask players to all be in a different quarter to try to receive the ball



"SAFE ZONES"

HELPS PLAYERS TRY THINGS WITHOUT PRESSURE

Example: "Place anywhere on the pitch for players to control the ball with no pressure"



PLAYER DEVELOPMENT

For the next 4 years we will be focusing on specific things for the children's development across what we call the Four Corners.

The four corners are 1. Technical, 2. Psychological, 3. Physical, 4. Social

Below you can see what our focus will be under each of the Four Corners as well as how we plan to do this at training and on a match-day.

THE FOUR CORNERS

TECHNICAL

Playing & experiencing different playing positions

Attacking & Defending individually, in groups and as a team

PSYCHOLOGICAL

Brilliant behaviours and attitudes towards self and others

Self belief and confidence

Creative thinking



PHYSICAL

Managing training and matchday exposure related to physical maturity

Physical skills developed within wider game practices

SOCIAL

Making friends and building relationships with team-mates

Giving respect to all

Managing emotions

Positive influences

OUR FOCUSED PRIORITIES AND HOW WE WILL DO IT

TECHNICAL DEVELOPMENT

We will provide opportunity for the children to develop their individual technique, in particular being able to control the ball and be comfortable on the ball. We will do this through game-realistic practice and also through un-opposed practice.

TIME TO THINK & BREATHE

We will provide the children with the space for them to overcome challenges and explore opportunities at their own pace. We will do this through effective coaching techniques such as posing problems, question & answer and demonstrations.

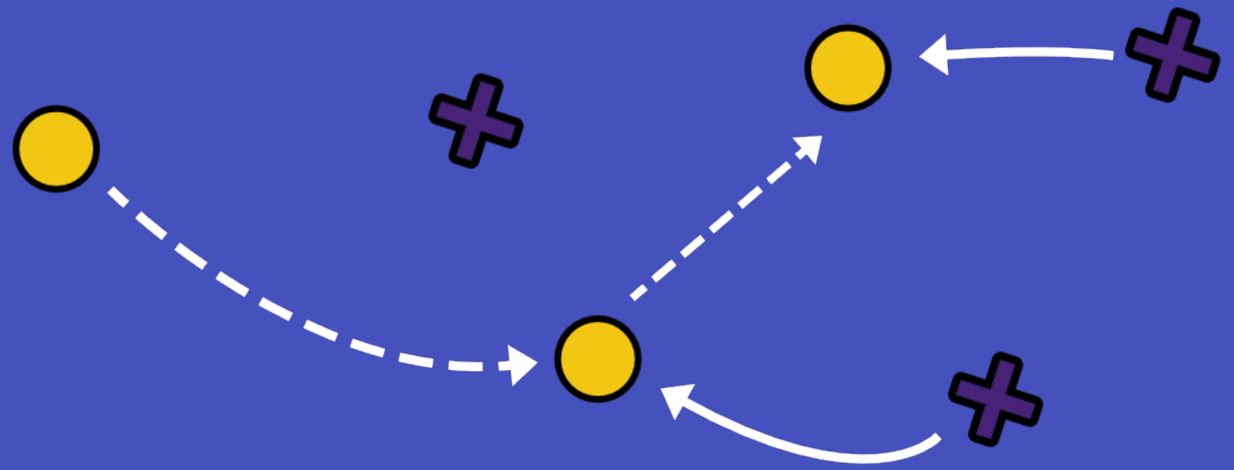
LEARNING THE FUNDAMENTALS

We will provide this window of opportunity to build strong and foundational movement skills such as agility, balance, coordination and speed. We will do this by adding specific exercises disguised within our training sessions.

EAST HULL FALCONS

FOOTBALL CLUB

HOW WE SUPPORT



SEASONS AND FORMATS

Below is the different playing formats our current U9s and U10s will experience each season up until the end of the 2029/30 season.

These are are what are known as format transitions.

At each transition the number of players on the pitch increase, as well as the pitch size, goal size and in some instances the ball size.

We pride ourselves on equal game time, this is when we try to ensure all players get the same and fair amount of playing time on a match-day. With this are some considerations we need to take into account and how you can also help. For example children will have instances where they may not feel like playing, may not be physically capable to match the opposition or not quite technically there with their technique.

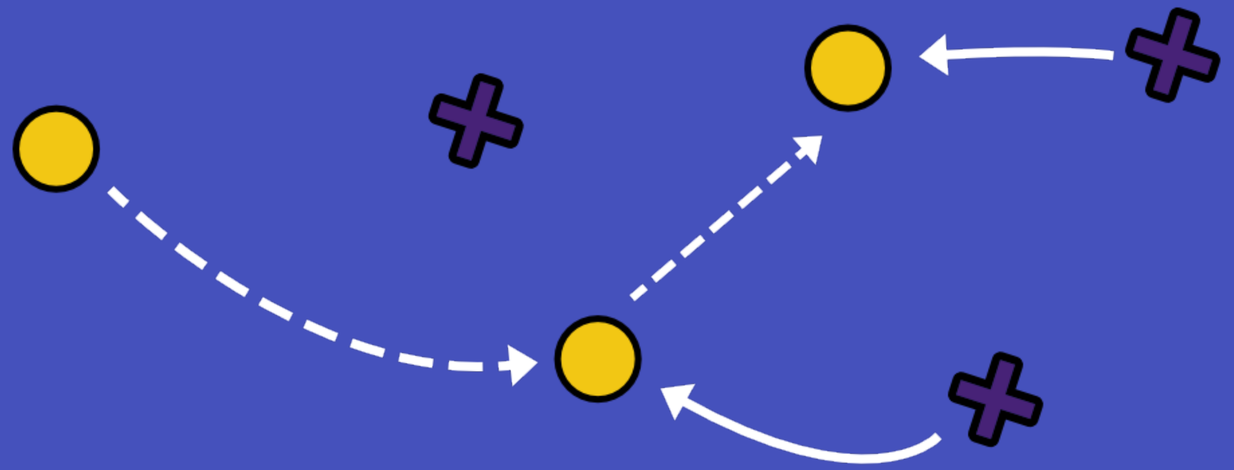
In these instances we value open communication with you and will make decisions on the safety of the children's health and well-being above everything else.

	2025/26	2026/27	2027/28	2028/29	2029/30
U9's	Format: 7v7 Pitch: 60x40 yd Goal: 12x6 ft Ball: Size 3	Format: 7v7 Pitch: 60x40 yd Goal: 12x6 ft Ball: Size 3	Format: 7v7 Pitch: 60x40 yd Goal: 12x6 ft Ball: Size 3	Format: 9v9 Pitch: 80x50 yd Goal: 16x7 ft Ball: Size 4	Format: 9v9 Pitch: 80x50 yd Goal: 16x7 ft Ball: Size 4
U10's	Format: 7v7 Pitch: 60x40 yd Goal: 12x6 ft Ball: Size 3	Format: 7v7 Pitch: 60x40 yd Goal: 12x6 ft Ball: Size 3	Format: 9v9 Pitch: 80x50 yd Goal: 16x7 ft Ball: Size 4	Format: 9v9 Pitch: 80x50 yd Goal: 16x7 ft Ball: Size 4	Format: 11v11 Pitch: 100x60 yd Goal: 21x6 ft Ball: Size 4

EAST HULL FALCONS

FOOTBALL CLUB

OUR PLAYERS



HOW TO BE THE BEST PLAYERS

Below are some of the messages we will share with the children when playing the different positions on the pitch. We ask you to share these with the children and help them understand these in addition to how we will encourage these during training and on a match-day.



GOALKEEPER

TO BE CONFIDENT WITH THE BALL IN YOUR HANDS OR AT YOUR FEET.

TO BE BRAVE TO DIVE TO MAKE SAVES.

TO NOT JUST STAY ON YOUR GOAL LINE.

TO BE BRAVE TO COME AND PICK THE BALL UP IN ANY PART OF YOUR AREA.

USE YOUR FULL AREA TO COME TOWARDS PLAYERS, MAKING YOUR GOAL SMALLER BEHIND YOU AND HARDER TO SCORE.

TO TALK TO YOUR TEAMMATES AND ENCOURAGE THEM TO HELP YOU DEFEND YOUR GOAL.



DEFENDER

TO BE CONFIDENT WITH THE BALL AND TO TRY AND KEEP THE BALL IF YOU WIN A TACKLE OR RECEIVE A PASS.

KNOW WHEN TO TRY TO TACKLE AND WHEN IT IS BETTER TO MAKE OTHER PLAYERS MAKE A MISTAKE BY PUTTING PRESSURE ON THEM.

TO KNOW WHERE YOU SHOULD BE ON THE PITCH AND HOW CLOSE OR FAR YOU SHOULD BE FROM YOUR OPPONENT.

TO WORK WITH YOUR DEFENDERS AND MIDFIELDERS TO NOT JUST CHASE THE BALL.

TO SUPPORT YOUR GOALKEEPER IN STOPPING GOALS.



MIDFIELDER

TO BE CONFIDENT WITH THE BALL AND TO TRY AND KEEP THE BALL IF YOU WIN A TACKLE OR RECEIVE A PASS.

KNOW WHEN TO TRY TO TACKLE AND WHEN IT IS BETTER TO MAKE OTHER PLAYERS MAKE A MISTAKE BY PUTTING PRESSURE ON THEM.

TO KNOW WHERE YOU SHOULD BE ON THE PITCH AND HOW CLOSE OR FAR YOU SHOULD BE FROM YOUR OPPONENT.

TO GET FORWARD TO HELP YOUR STRIKERS AND GET BACK TO HELP YOUR DEFENDERS.

BE BRAVE TO TRY SKILLS, RUN WITH THE BALL AND SHOOT AT GOAL.



ATTACKER

TO KNOW WHEN TO TRY AND TACKLE THEIR DEFENDERS AND WHEN TO MAKE THEM GO IN A CERTAIN DIRECTION.

ALWAYS BE THE NEAREST PLAYER TO THE OPPONENTS GOAL AND ALWAYS BE IN SPACE TO RECEIVE THE BALL AND ATTACK.

KNOW WHEN TO DRIBBLE AND GO PAST AN OPPONENT, WHEN YOU NEED TO PASS AND BE BRAVE TO SHOOT WHEN YOU HAVE THE OPPORTUNITY TO DO SO.

ALWAYS TRY TO SHOOT TO THE SIDE OF THEIR GOALKEEPER USING ANY PART OR EITHER FOOT.

HOW YOU CAN HELP US AND THEM

As a parent or guardian you have the fantastic opportunity to be able to provide that constant and consistent support away from training and a match-day.

To effectively do this here are our top tips for you:

TRAINING

Ensure they demonstrate the values and behaviours we want to see from our children

Allow the coaches to 'coach' and do not go against any of the messages we are communicating.

Place trust in the process, we are not developing the children for the game on the weekend, we are developing them for a long lasting love and understanding of football.

Do not focus in on any mistakes, we are here to build confidence and resilience.

If the children do look to you be cautious in your body language and the way you talk to them - negative displays of this can lead to negative behaviours and a shattering of their confidence.

We are here to develop all players, they will be players striving to keep up and those thriving ahead across different areas of the four corners, don't be judgemental on yours or other children, it all takes time

MATCHDAY

Ensure they demonstrate the values and behaviours we want to see from our children.

Don't be a touchline coach, they are not players on a playstation to control.

Recognise and appreciate their naivety and their current understanding of the game and their current ability - they may not be able to do what we are thinking.

Encourage and praise effort, this is more important at this age over execution.

Be prepared to accept mistakes in a positive way that encourages them to try again.

Don't feel you need to be vocal or provide instruction if the coach is quiet, this will be intentional to allow the children to make their own decisions, and provides opportunity to see if what we work on in training is beginning to be understood and applied on a match-day.

Represent yourself and the club well, adhere to our codes of conduct and be a welcoming and positive enviroment for our team and others.

AT HOME

Don't focus on the result of a game, the mistake they may have made or the opportunity they didn't take - focus on how it made them feel, what they did take from training or a match that is positive.

Support them emotionally and on their behaviours, encouraging them to represent themselves, yourself and the club well at all times.

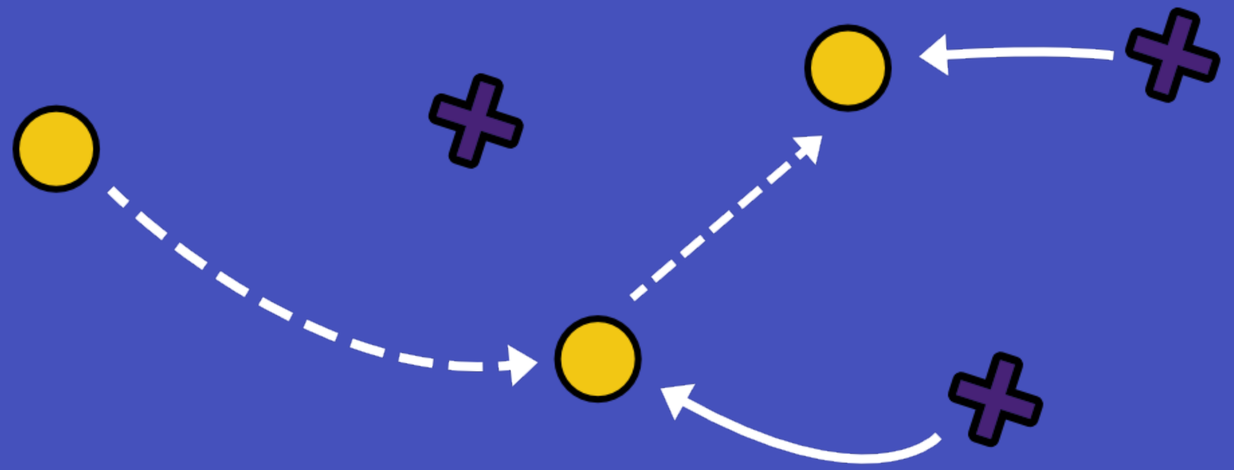
Create an environment and support them in developing their technique at home, we want to ignite a passion for the game and a passion to improve away from when they are with us.

Try not to reward them to much with materialistic things e.g £5 for every goal scored, this could lead to selfish behaviour and outcomes over their long term development.

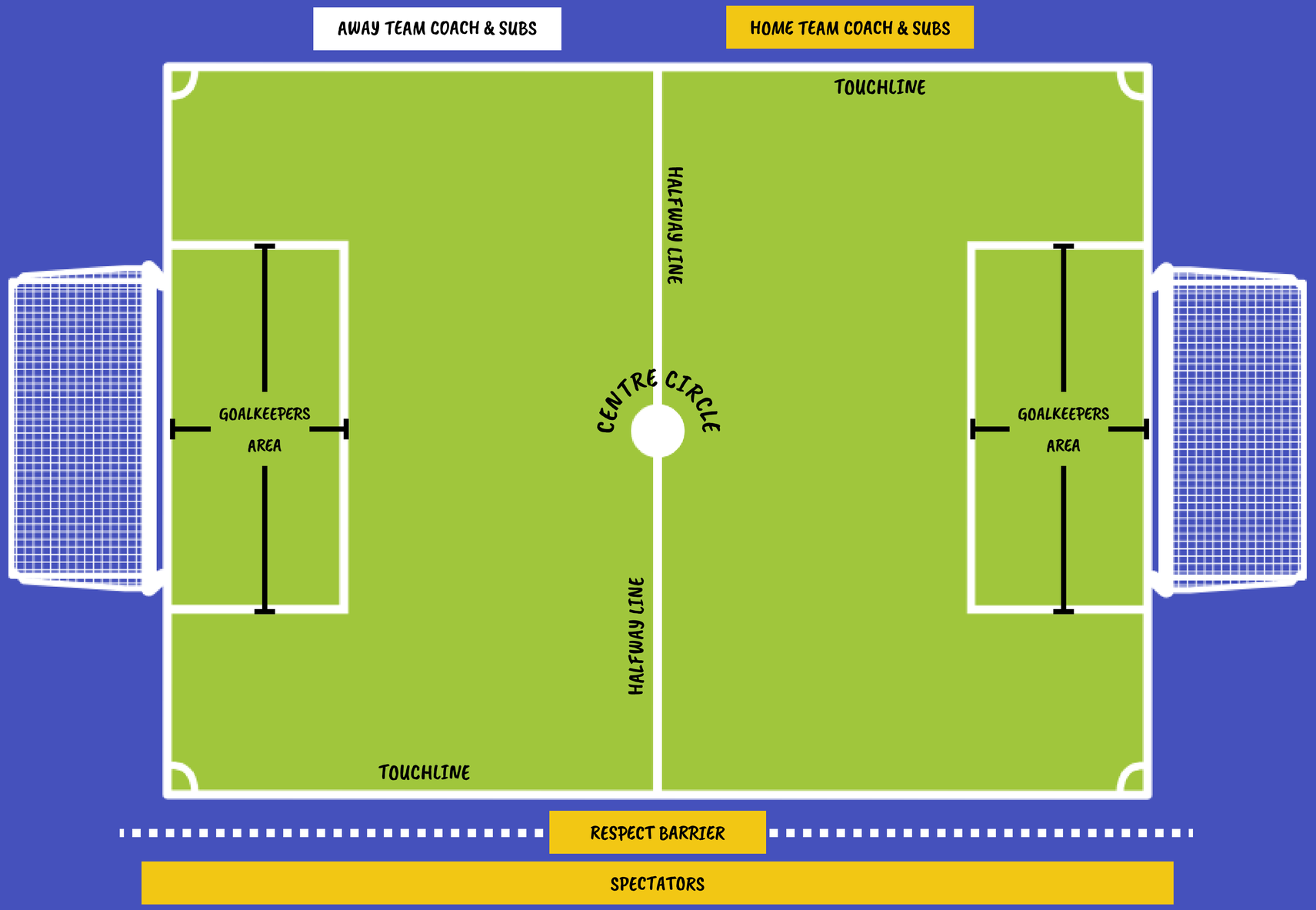
Encourage them to seek out opportunities to learn for example watching the game being played, computer games or highlights / training tutorials on YouTube.

EAST HULL FALCONS FOOTBALL CLUB

MATCHDAY RULES



THE PITCH



PITCH SIZE: The pitch size for U9s and U10s is 60x40 yards.

GOAL SIZE: The goal size for U9s and U10s is 12x6 feet.

BALL SIZE: The ball size for U9s and U10s is Size 3.

KICK OFFS: These are taken from the centre circle in the middle of the pitch.

RETREAT LINE: The team without the ball moves back into their own half of the pitch when a goal kick is taken.

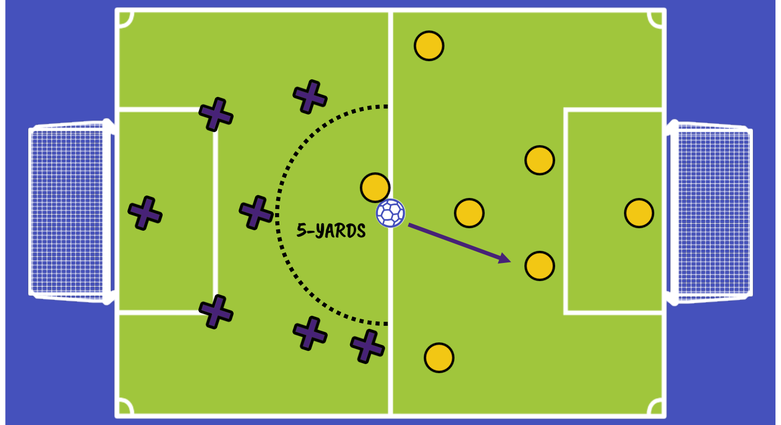
MANAGERS & COACHES: Team managers and coaches are within an area on opposite side of the pitch to spectators.

SUBSTITUTES: Substitutes should be with their teams manager and coaches.

SPECTATORS: Are on the opposite side of the pitch to the teams managers and coaches and must remain behind the respect barrier.

UNDERSTANDING MATCHDAY RULES

KICK OFF AND RESTARTS AFTER A GOAL IS SCORED

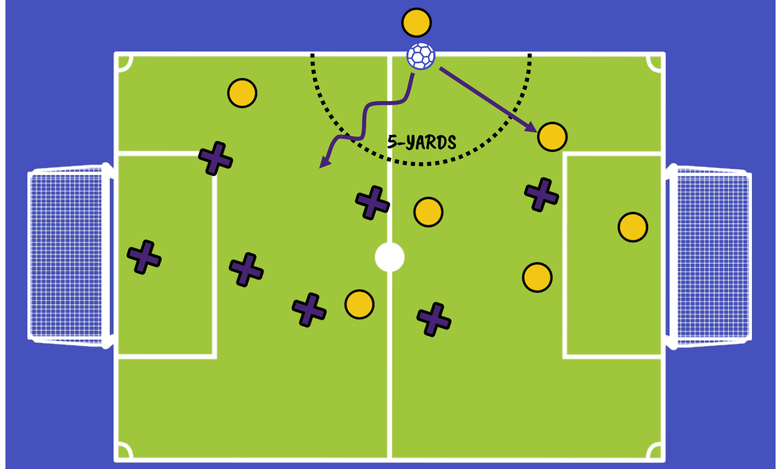


A Kick Off from the centre of the pitch starts the game, or restarts the game after a goal is scored.

It can be taken in any direction (forwards, backwards or sideways).

The opposing team must be a minimum of 5 yards away in their own half of the pitch.

TOUCHLINE PASS OR DRIBBLE IN

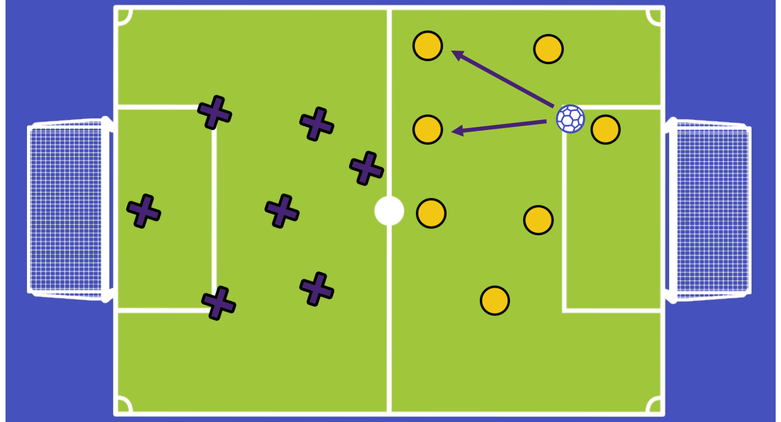


When the ball crosses the touchline, the team who's ball it, 1 player can either pass the ball in or dribble the ball in.

The other team must be a minimum of 5-yards away in any direction.

A goal cannot be scored directly from a touchline restart.

GOAL KICK



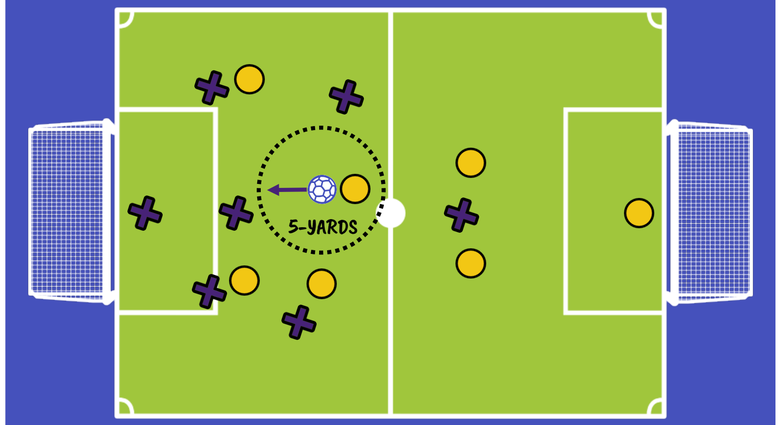
If the opposing team shoots and the ball goes over the goal line wide of the goal it is a goal kick.

A goal kick can be taken from anywhere inside the penalty box.

The opposing team must be back in their own half of the pitch.

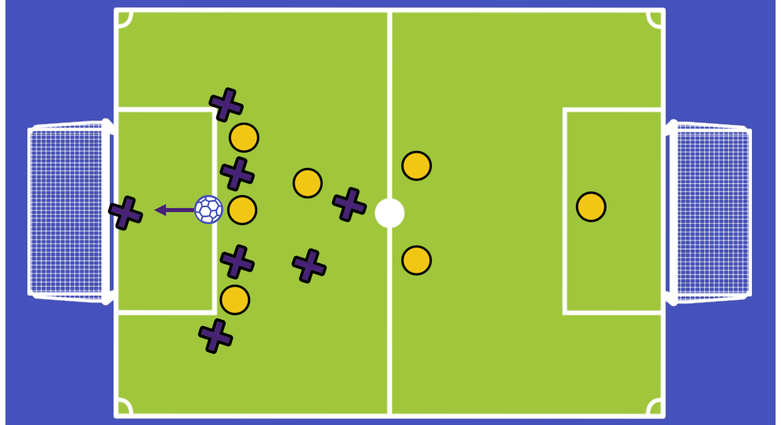
UNDERSTANDING MATCHDAY RULES

FREE KICKS



For all Free Kicks the defending teams players must be a minimum of 5-yards away from the ball in any direction.

PENALTY KICKS

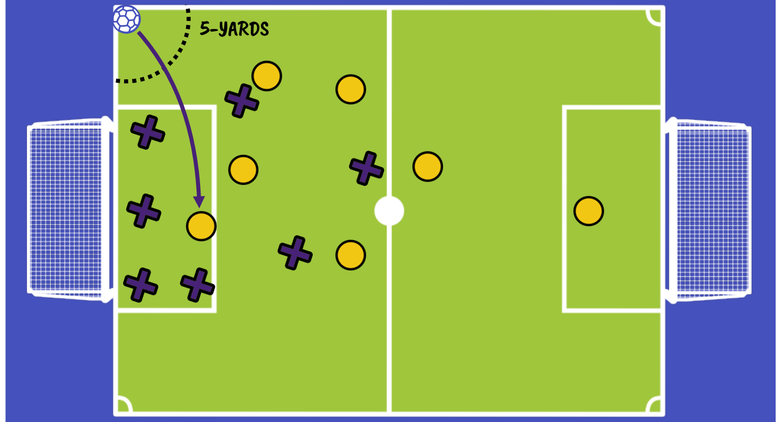


If a foul is given in the penalty area by the defending teams player, a penalty kick will be awarded.

All players except the goalkeeper and the player taking the penalty must be outside the penalty area.

The penalty must be kicked forwards towards the goal.

CORNER KICKS



If a defending player kicks the ball over their own goal line wide of the goal, it's a corner kick for the attacking team.

The defending team players must remain at least 5-yards from the ball until it is kicked into play.

The player taking the corner cannot touch the ball once kicked until another player touches the ball.

UNDERSTANDING MATCHDAY RULES

FOULS AND MISCONDUCT

Free kicks are awarded when a foul is committed.

All free kicks are direct, except when a deliberate header has occurred.

A goalkeeper is not allowed to pick the ball up if it has been deliberately kicked to them by a teammate.

If this happens a free kick should be given on the penalty area line closest to where the incident occurs.

Deliberately heading the ball is an offence punishable by an indirect free kick. The indirect free kick is taken at the point where the ball was deliberately headed, except: Where a player deliberately heads the ball within their own penalty area, the referee will stop the game and restart with an indirect free kick to the opposition from the nearest side line of the penalty area where it took place.

OFFSIDES

There are no off-sides in U9s and U10s football.

Players can be in any area of the pitch at any time apart from when it's a kick off or a goal kick.

POWER PLAY LAW

If a team goes on to be losing by a four goal difference a further additional player can be added – so 7v7 becomes 7v8.

The main aim of the Power Play option is that all players are being challenged and enjoying the game.

Power Play is available through all mini soccer football formats 5v5 and 7v7.

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East Hull Falcons U9s & U10s

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